

amenities. (After selecting a venue, the next step is to plan the layout, logistics, and technical requirements.) Making sure the venue aligns with your event's theme and goals can significantly enhance the attendee experience and boost overall satisfaction.

Searching for event venues should be one of the first steps in the planning process, as many venues are only available during certain seasons or for specific occasions. Large venues, for example, may have limited availability early in the year due to high demand from sales conferences and other corporate events. When selecting a venue, several factors should be considered, including cost, travel time for attendees, available facilities, type of on-site staff, security policies, restrooms, emergency safety protocols, venue capacity, parking options, and audiovisual capabilities.

5. Choose Event Management Software

Event management software helps organizers with promotion, registration, organization etc, before and during the event. Some technology helps the organizers before the event, such as registration and ticket software. Here's a list of potential aspects that may require event management software,

- Project management technology
- Live streaming and recording
- Engagement, such as social media
- Attendee management
- Marketing and promotion
- Event website
- Virtual and hybrid event solutions

6. Selecting Vendors, Sponsors, and Partners

In event management, vendors provide essential services that enhance the guest experience, such as food, entertainment, transportation, seating, and security. Some venues may also offer preferred vendors or volunteers to help maintain order throughout the event.

Sponsors and partners can support the event by promoting, funding, organizing, or providing staff. It is important to carefully evaluate these organizations before selecting them as sponsors or partners. Their legitimacy and ability to contribute to the event should be verified. Corporate sponsors might fund specific aspects of the event, like catering, while local businesses may donate supplies in exchange for promotional opportunities.

7. Plan the Program and Entertainment

An event's program and entertainment influence the general attendance of the occasion. The first step in organizing a program is to determine the main attraction of the event. Before selecting entertainment or activities, it is important to consider the audience's interests, the type of event, what kind of program will attract attendees, and the available space at the venue.

For example, a spacious venue may allow for multiple workshops or guest speakers. If the event includes inviting speakers or special guests, they can be found through social media platforms, professional networks, or industry publications.

8. Brand and Market the Event

A strong theme or brand can help attract attention to the event. This can include creating a logo, colour palette, and a consistent style for key elements such as the event name, tagline, and overall visual identity. Branding should also extend to graphics, tone, messaging, and promotional materials.

The next step is to develop a marketing plan. Use a mix of channels, such as social media, television, radio, email, advertisements, posters, and content marketing, to reach a wider audience. It's also important to choose channels that are commonly used by the target audience to ensure better engagement.

9. Determine an Event day Schedule

The next step is to determine a schedule for the day of the event so vendors, staff, volunteers, and guests may arrive at a specific time. It is necessary to create an agenda that covers the entire day, including initial setup, dining schedules, entertainment time slots, and disassembly for the event after guests leave. It is also considered assigning event planning team members to specific time slots and providing details about their duties and requirements. This may help maintain accountability throughout the entire event. Some additional measures we want to follow on the day of the event may include:

- Remind guests of the event
- Check the layout and setup of the venue before guests arrive
- Contact vendors, sponsors, partners and media attendees
- Create a specific area for event staff
- Check with the event planning team throughout the day
- Check all electronic equipment
- Prepare emergency supplies, such as first aid kits

10. Execution and Evaluation

The final step in event planning includes execution on the event day and evaluation afterward. Successful execution involves coordinating staff, managing schedules, and promptly addressing any on-site issues. After the event, collecting feedback through surveys is essential to assess its success and identify areas for improvement. Continuous evaluation helps refine processes and build on strengths for future events.

Event planners often use specific metrics to measure success. Consider tracking data such as ticket sales, product sales, pre-orders, and social media growth. Reviewing social media engagement, attendee surveys, and feedback from speakers or partners also provides valuable insights. It is equally important to meet with the event planning team to discuss what went well and identify areas for improvement in future events.

1.14 CONCLUSION

Event management offers exciting career opportunities in various fields such as music launches, weddings, theme parties, private parties, award ceremonies, product launches, exhibitions, fashion shows, community events, trade shows, birthday parties, corporate events, and more. The growing willingness of people to spend on events, along with the commercialization of event management, has made it a promising career option for the younger generation. Events, public or private, commercial or charitable, celebratory or commemorative, create opportunities for people to come together, share experiences, and achieve meaningful outcomes.

